

Samsung Galaxy S Femme

Samsung Galaxy S Femme is a variation of the Galaxy S phone which is designed specifically for women

Mercedes-Benz go green

Mercedes-Benz launches 95 horsepower A-class electric car that has a top speed of 93 mph with its 70kW motor



Lenovo's IdeaPad Z460 is an affordable laptop

tive, and put function keys where Ctrl should be are a strict no-no. The thumb-rule is to use the keypad on the demo piece for at least a few minutes, and do some regular tasks, and write out something. If you struggle, then the keyboard (and laptop model) is not for you. Something you should look out for is multi-touch track-pads. These are just great to use once you get the hang of things, and you will never be able to go back to regular track-pads later. If you like huge screen laptops, make sure you find one that has a number pad inbuilt into the keyboard – you'll be able to work much faster with a dedicated number-pad.

THE HYPE

You're going to be bombarded with advertisements, special offers and more this Diwali, and it's important to know what's just hype, and what isn't.

The categories

When it comes to laptops, you're often told that some models are Ultra-compact, or business series, gaming, etc. What you need to remember is that, just like desktops, you should always try to get the most powerful hardware for your budget. Buy based on usage, and not on looks alone, and you will always buy smart. If you don't plan on computing on the move very often, buying an ultra-compact for a lot more money doesn't make sense. If you hardly game, and buy a gaming laptop, that won't make much sense either. The business series from most manufacturers are usually filled with security features, and are more sober-looking than their lifestyle cousins. However, we've often found that the lower-end business series are decent buys, even if you're still a student, because the less

fancy designs mean that more attention was paid to the innards of the machine – better hardware, or sturdier chassis, etc.

What's in a name?

Just like we all want flashy racing cars, and own designer wear, a lot of us want our laptops to be fashion statements. Named after big car makers, or designed by famous folk, there are laptop models that exist purely for flaunt value. If you have the money to spend on them, you can choose to show-off to your friends. However, if you're taking an EMI-scheme, and buying one to increase your productivity, don't consider these designer brands. For the same price you would be able to buy a much more powerful laptop that would keep you future-proofed for at least a year more.

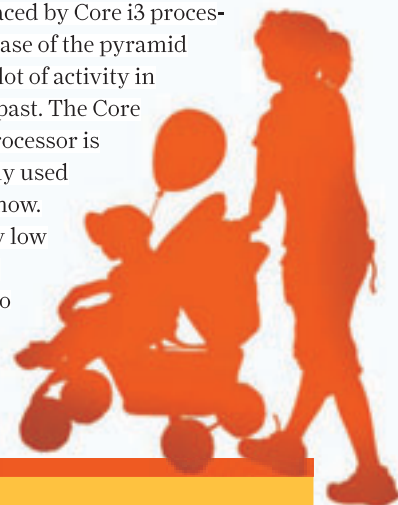
Are we dead yet?

Some of the technologies people were raving about just a couple of years ago are not really popular today. However, this will not stop manufacturers from throwing them in to some of their models. We're talking about stuff like biometrics. Although a good concept, bad implementation means that the webcam or fingerprint reader doesn't always work as advertised. We've bought a couple of such laptops ourselves, which is why we speak from experience. Sometimes face-recognition doesn't work after a haircut, or if you haven't shaved, and all six of the



Sony's CW series are an affordable yet stylish line of laptops

laptops we've used which had fingerprint readers suspiciously developed some hardware problem just after warranty expired. It's no big deal, but the track record of such things is barely passable. These days, manufacturers are busy upgrading their laptops. Intel's Core 2 processors are being phased out and being replaced by Core i3 processors. The base of the pyramid has seen a lot of activity in the recent past. The Core i3 350M processor is a commonly used processor now. For a really low budget, it's advisable to go with an entry-level



SERIES UNLINKED

The most important thing you should do, even before you choose a model, is to research the brands. Look for abundant service centres in your area and the type and duration of the warranty offered. For example, a model that carries two-year doorstep warranty is preferred to one that offers two-year carry in warranty. You'd rather have someone come to your house to fix something rather than have to make time to go to the service centre. You should also find out how many service centres are in your area, and try and do some online research to read about other people's experiences with that brand. Remember to keep the searches local, because although a brand might have great service in Delhi or Mumbai, it may not in your city, just as a brand may have a terrible reputation in some other city, but can have a strong base in yours. Lastly, we recommend that ALL of you shell out a little more but purchase an extended warranty. At least 3 total years of warranty is what we recommend for laptops. Also remember to insist that the dealer fill out the warranty card with all of the required information, and keep these documents safely. As soon as you reach home after your purchase, go to the manufacturer's web site and register yourself and your laptop. This will help you in case there are any problems in the future.